

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ -
 ♥ K 6 3
 ♦ K J 10 9 4 2
 ♣ 10 9 6 2

♠ 8 5
 ♥ Q J 10 9 7 4 2
 ♦ 5
 ♣ K J 8

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K Q J 10 7 4 3
 ♥ 5
 ♦ Q 3
 ♣ Q 7 5

♠ A 9 6 2
 ♥ A 8
 ♦ A 8 7 6
 ♣ A 4 3

West	North	East	South
	3♥	3♠	4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

You estimate your hand has 6 playing tricks. That is reasonable for a preemptive 3♥ bid. East overcalls 3♠ and partner bids 4♥. Everybody passes.

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠K.

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Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 1 : Total = 3

This looks way too easy. If the ♥ finesse works and the ♣ finesse works you could make 6. It is when things look too easy that you should look for danger! What if you play the ♠A and West ruffs. What if West also gets a trick with the ♥K and East gets a trick with the ♣Q. What with your ♠ loser you would be down 1.

East probably has a 7-card suit to overcall at the 3-level, so if you play the ♠A West will ruff and one of your winners will disappear. So don't play the ♠A. Duck and let East win the trick while West shows out as expected. East will lead the ♠Q and you duck again. So East will lead the ♠J and you duck one more time, but now you can ruff in your hand.

Lead your ♥Q and finesse, West winning the ♥K. West will probably return a ♦ which you win in dummy. Play the ♥A. Then ruff a ♦ to get back to your hand and pull any trumps left out. Play a ♣ to dummy's ♣A and at long last play dummy's ♠A and discard your ♣ loser.

You always had 10 winners in this hand, as long as one of them didn't disappear.

To make sure the ♠A didn't disappear you had to hold it until West no longer had a trump.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A Q
 ♥ A K
 ♦ A K Q 10 2
 ♣ J 10 7 6

♠ 6 5 2
 ♥ Q 10 7 3
 ♦ 7
 ♣ A 8 5 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 8 7 3
 ♥ J 8 4 2
 ♦ 9 6 3
 ♣ K Q

♠ J 10 9 4
 ♥ 9 6 5
 ♦ J 8 5 4
 ♣ 9 4

West	North	East	South
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♦	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by East

of them once the ♣A is gone. A 3-2 split in ♦s will assure 2 more ♦ tricks. There are lots of possibilities but you must be careful of entries and unblocking. In particular, you only have one entry to your hand (if you don't waste the ♠Q) and that is the ♣K Q. So you need to be sure to unblock the ♠A Q before you try to get to your hand in ♣s.

But there is something you **MUST** do first - test the ♦s. You win the ♠A and play ♦A, ♦K. North shows out on the second ♦! Now you unblock your ♠Q, then lead a ♣ to your ♣Q. Assume a defender takes the ♣A and plays a ♠. You win the ♠K, then the ♣K. Next a ♦ toward dummy, finessing South out of the ♦J. Dummy is now high.

What if you had carried out the plan up to the point when you led a ♣ toward your hand and the defense didn't take their ♣A?

You must abandon ♣s temporarily and take the ♦ finesse. You take your good ♦s and then go back to ♣s.

With 9 points opposite an opening 2♣ bid you are too strong for a negative response.

A suit response would promise a 5-card suit so you bid 2NT. Partner says 4♣.

Partner's jump to 4♣ over your 2NT is Gerber convention.

You have no Aces so you respond 4♦. Partner bids 6NT.

East to play 6NT. South leads the ♠J.

East to play 6NT. South leads the ♠J.

Winners: ♠ 3 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 0 : Total = 8

You need 4 more winners. The ♣ suit will provide 3 of them once the ♣A is gone. A 3-2 split in ♦s will assure 2 more ♦ tricks. There are lots of possibilities but you must be careful of entries and unblocking. In particular, you only have one entry to your hand (if you don't waste the ♠Q) and that is the ♣K Q. So you need to be sure to unblock the ♠A Q before you try to get to your hand in ♣s.